

Auteur: Odia Kibor
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$$\int \frac{2x^3 dx}{\sqrt{x^2 + 4}}$$

$$u = x^2 + 4$$

$$du = 2x dx$$

$$2x^3 dx = x^2(2x dx)$$

$$x^2 = u - 4$$

$$\Rightarrow \int \frac{x^2(2x dx)}{\sqrt{x^2 + 4}}$$

$$= \int \frac{u - 4}{\sqrt{u}} du$$

$$= \int \frac{u}{\sqrt{u}} du - 4 \int \frac{1}{\sqrt{u}} du$$

$$= \int u^{1-\frac{1}{2}} du - 4 \int u^{-1/2} du$$

$$= \frac{2}{3}(x^2 + 4)^{\frac{3}{2}} - 8(x^2 + 4)^{\frac{1}{2}} + C$$

$$= \frac{2}{3}\sqrt{(x^2 + 4)^3} - 8\sqrt{x^2 + 4} + C$$

References